FOUNDING PARTNERSHIP PROSPECTUS · 2026

ScienceClaw

Build the collective that builds the future of science.

Partner with 150 curated builders creating decentralized agent collectives for consequential scientific and technical problems.

Oct 30 – Nov 1, 2026 | MIT Media Lab | scienceclawhack.ai

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Laboratory for Atomistic and Molecular Mechanics

The next leap in scientific AI is *coordination.*

Today’s most capable agents still operate inside isolated stacks. Science advances differently: specialized people, tools, datasets, simulations, and laboratories contribute distinct capabilities to a shared result.

TODAY

Isolated assistants

One interface, one toolchain, one bounded context.

NEXT

Scientific collectives

Specialized agents discover capabilities, coordinate across digital and physical systems, and leave traceable artifacts others can extend.

ScienceClaw at a glance

A three-day, in-person hackathon for building decentralized agent collectives that solve real scientific and technical problems.

150	3 days	2–5	4
CURATED BUILDERS	IN PERSON	BUILDERS PER TEAM	CHALLENGE AREAS

Target cohort spanning MIT, Harvard, RISD, invited universities, startups, companies, and research laboratories.

What teams build and validate

01

Problem

Choose a difficult, open-ended, consequential scientific or technical challenge.

02

System

Build a functioning decentralized agentic system—not only a concept or architecture.

03

Result

Demonstrate what the system actually accomplishes.

04

Validation

Support the result with evidence, benchmarks, comparison, or real-world validation.

Science is the benchmark.

Four challenge areas

A·01

Biology & Protein Design

Hypothesize, design, and iterate across sequence, structure, and function.

A·02

Robotics & Physical Agency

Reach beyond the browser into robots, sensors, and cloud laboratories.

A·03

Manufacturing & Materials

Close the loop from simulation and candidate discovery to fabrication.

A·04

Open Scientific Challenge

Participant- and sponsor-defined problems that cross conventional domains.

One overall competition. Teams can work across areas and combine any model, framework, or architecture.

The event is a multi-agent experiment

LEVEL 01

Agents

Specialized models and tools collaborate within teams.

LEVEL 02

Teams

Teams exchange resources, agents, data, and discoveries.

LEVEL 03

Ecosystem

Successful capabilities propagate because they make other systems stronger.

COLLABORATION BONUS · +10 Teams earn additional credit when another team successfully reuses what they build.

Where partners enter the collective

Bring a difficult problem or a capability teams can compose into working systems.

01
Challenges
Consequential problems and evaluation criteria.

02
Data
Scientific corpora and domain datasets.

03
Models & APIs
Frontier, open, or specialized intelligence.

04
Compute
Credits and infrastructure for experimentation.

05
Physical systems
Robots, sensors, hardware, fabrication, and labs.

06
People
Technical mentors, researchers, and evaluators.

What partners gain

DEPLOY

Product adoption & testing

Put technology into the hands of multidisciplinary teams working on real problems.

DISCOVER

Technical insight

Observe unexpected integrations, failure modes, and high-value use cases.

CONNECT

Curated talent access

Work directly with builders selected for demonstrated technical or research ability.

LEAD

Category leadership

Help define responsible, open infrastructure for the internet of scientific agents.

A partner journey, not a logo placement

BEFORE

Shape the entry point

→ Co-design a challenge or resource

→ Prepare onboarding and evaluation

→ Introduce the capability to participants

DURING

Build alongside teams

→ Teach a technical workshop

→ Mentor and troubleshoot

→ Join demos and judging

AFTER

Carry outcomes forward

→ Review projects and integrations

→ Receive opt-in talent/project access

→ Continue selected relationships

09 · EVENT IMPACT

What sponsorship unlocks

Every contribution removes a real bottleneck between a strong idea and a validated system.

PRIZE POOL

Reward functioning, consequential, and rigorously validated work.

COMPUTE & TOKENS

Keep experimentation from stopping at the first expensive run.

HARDWARE & LAB ACCESS

Let agents act on the physical world, not only in a browser.

PARTICIPANT EXPERIENCE

Support meals, safe operations, and three focused days of building.

Four ways to build with us

SUPPORTER

$5K

Visibility, two passes, mentors, and showcase access.

BUILDER

$15K

Adds a workshop, toolkit placement, demo table, and opt-in directory.

PLATFORM

$30K

Adds a challenge, judging, prominent branding, and curated introductions.

PRESENTING

$50K

Adds premier attribution, stage time, private preview, and an outcomes report.

LIMITED TO ONE

Benefits compound upward. Cash and in-kind support can be combined into a tailored partnership.

Founding partnership benefits

BENEFIT	SUPPORTER	BUILDER	PLATFORM	PRESENTING
Representative passes	2	4	6	8
Technical mentors	●	●	●	●
Website and sponsor acknowledgment	●	●	Prominent	Premier
Workshop or technical session	—	30 min	45 min	60 min
Participant toolkit and demo table	—	●	●	●
Opt-in project and talent directory	—	Post-event	Post-event	Post-event
Sponsor challenge and prize	—	—	●	●
Judging seat and curated introductions	—	—	●	●
Opening remarks and private demo preview	—	—	—	●
Tailored outcomes report	—	—	—	●

CAPABILITY PARTNER · IN KIND

Compute, APIs, models, datasets, robots, sensors, fabrication, or laboratory access. Recognition is based on usable event value and support—not list price.

Sponsorship supports access and participation—not guaranteed outcomes or favorable judging. Participant information is shared only with explicit consent.

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fw2@mit.edu scienceclawhack.ai | Oct 30 – Nov 1, 2026 · MIT Media Lab

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